



# News Release

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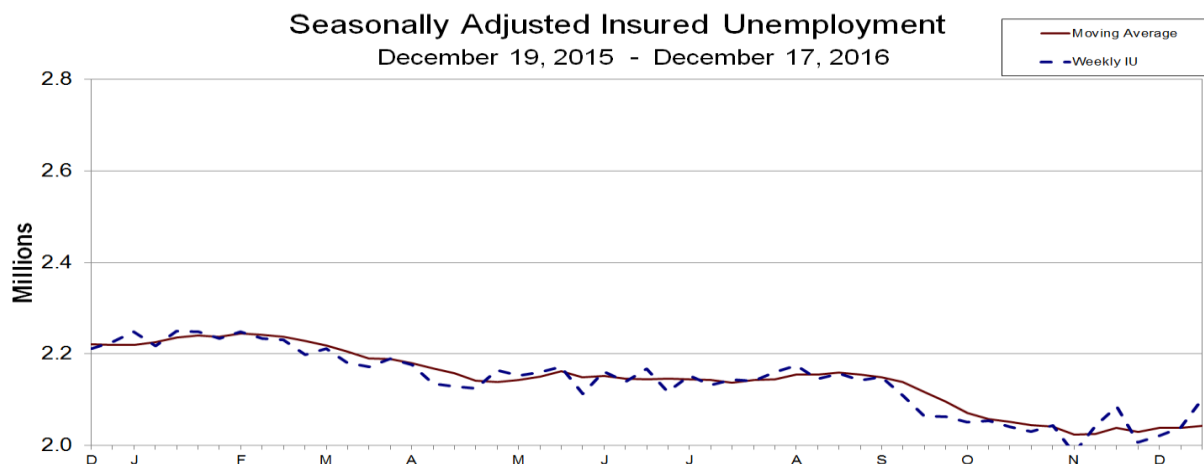
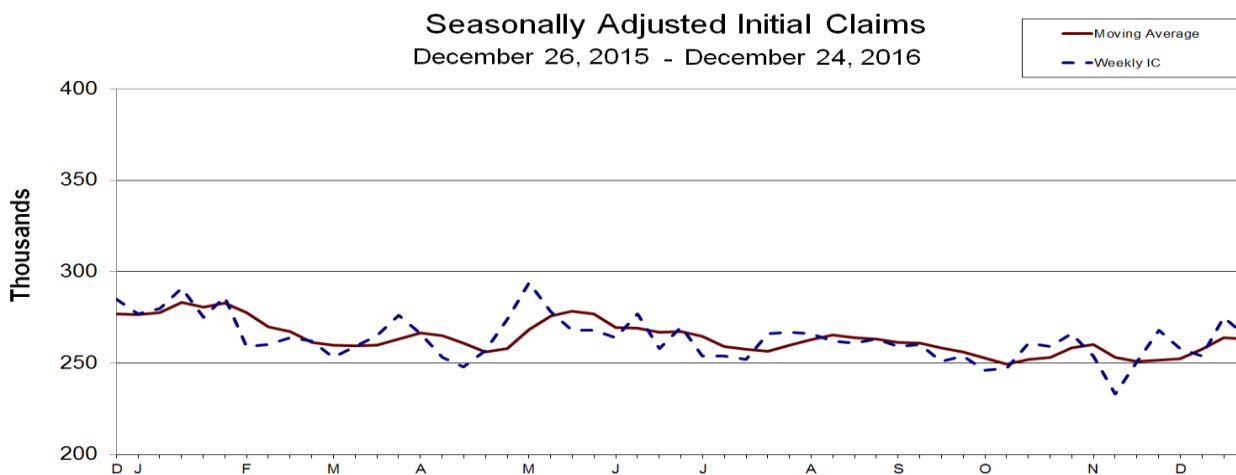
## UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE WEEKLY CLAIMS

### SEASONALLY ADJUSTED DATA

In the week ending December 24, the advance figure for seasonally adjusted **initial claims** was 265,000, a decrease of 10,000 from the previous week's unrevised level of 275,000. The 4-week moving average was 263,000, a decrease of 750 from the previous week's unrevised average of 263,750.

There were no special factors impacting this week's initial claims. This marks 95 consecutive weeks of initial claims below 300,000, the longest streak since 1970.

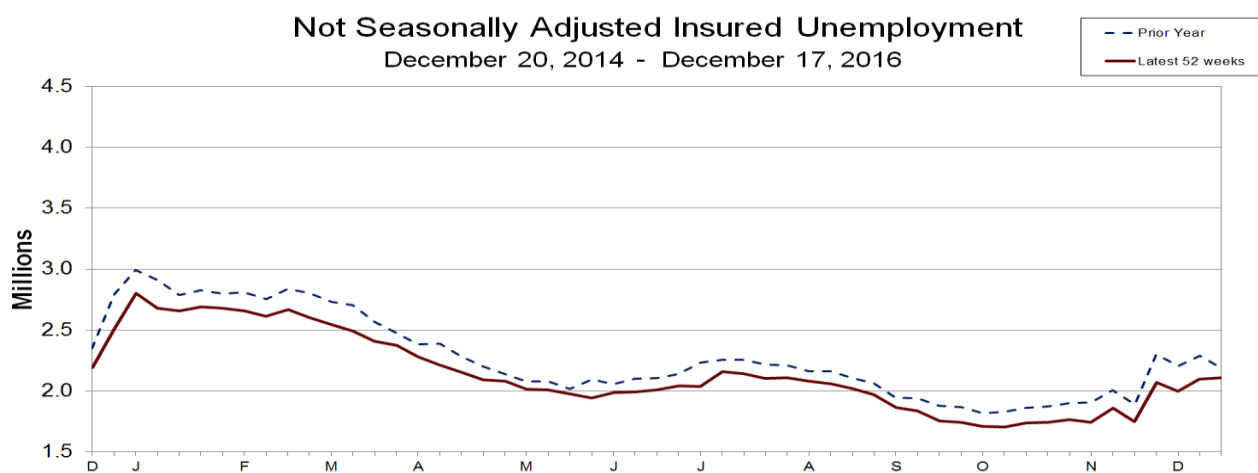
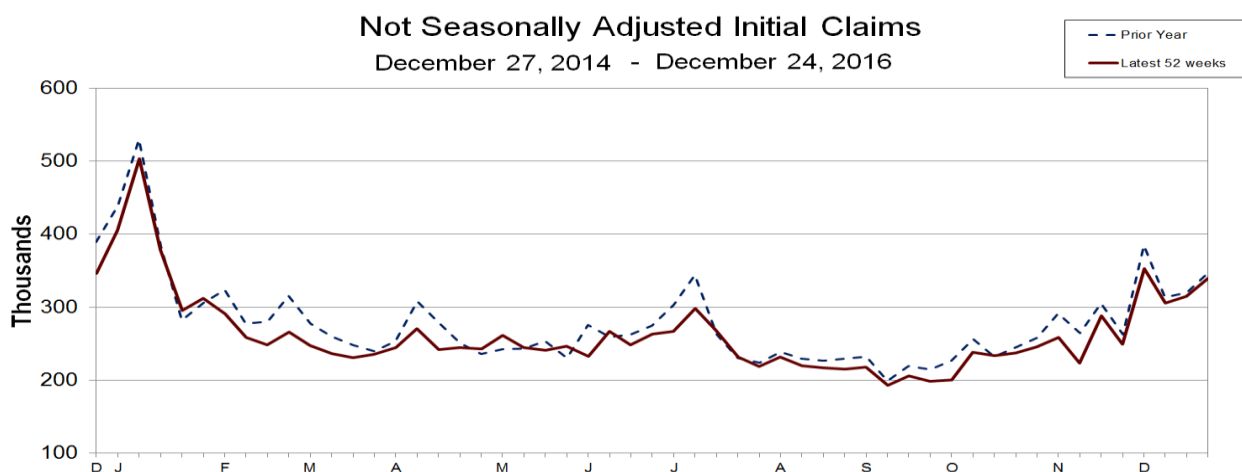
The advance seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment rate** was 1.5 percent for the week ending December 17, unchanged from the previous week's unrevised rate. The advance number for seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment** during the week ending December 17 was 2,102,000, an increase of 63,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised up 3,000 from 2,036,000 to 2,039,000. The 4-week moving average was 2,042,250, an increase of 4,500 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised up by 750 from 2,037,000 to 2,037,750.



## UNADJUSTED DATA

The advance number of actual initial claims under state programs, unadjusted, totaled 340,022 in the week ending December 24, an increase of 24,915 (or 7.9 percent) from the previous week. The seasonal factors had expected an increase of 37,945 (or 12.0 percent) from the previous week. There were 346,542 initial claims in the comparable week in 2015.

The advance unadjusted insured unemployment rate was 1.5 percent during the week ending December 17, unchanged from the prior week. The advance unadjusted number for persons claiming UI benefits in state programs totaled 2,108,467, an increase of 10,797 (or 0.5 percent) from the preceding week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 53,002 (or -2.5 percent) from the previous week. A year earlier the rate was 1.6 percent and the volume was 2,191,682.



The total number of people claiming benefits in all programs for the week ending December 10 was 2,140,465, an increase of 102,430 from the previous week. There were 2,336,519 persons claiming benefits in all programs in the comparable week in 2015.

No state was triggered "on" the Extended Benefits program during the week ending December 10.

Initial claims for UI benefits filed by former Federal civilian employees totaled 1,313 in the week ending December 17, an increase of 225 from the prior week. There were 947 initial claims filed by newly discharged veterans, a decrease of 136 from the preceding week.

There were 14,066 former Federal civilian employees claiming UI benefits for the week ending December 10, an increase of 2,060 from the previous week. Newly discharged veterans claiming benefits totaled 13,250, an increase of 722 from the prior week.

The highest insured unemployment rates in the week ending December 10 were in Alaska (4.8), Montana (2.6), New Jersey (2.5), Puerto Rico (2.4), California (2.3), Pennsylvania (2.3), Connecticut (2.2), Wyoming (2.2), the Virgin Islands (2.1), and West Virginia (2.1).

The largest increases in initial claims for the week ending December 17 were in Ohio (+2,625), Wisconsin (+2,083), Michigan (+1,683), Massachusetts (+1,510), and New Jersey (+1,380), while the largest decreases were in Pennsylvania (-1,521), Georgia (-1,500), Colorado (-818), Florida (-808), and West Virginia (-737).

## UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE DATA FOR REGULAR STATE PROGRAMS

| WEEK ENDING                                                 | December 24 | December 17 | Change  | December 10 | <a href="#">Prior Year<sup>1</sup></a> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|---------|-------------|----------------------------------------|
| Initial Claims (SA)                                         | 265,000     | 275,000     | -10,000 | 254,000     | 285,000                                |
| Initial Claims (NSA)                                        | 340,022     | 315,107     | +24,915 | 305,333     | 346,542                                |
| 4-Wk Moving Average (SA)                                    | 263,000     | 263,750     | -750    | 257,750     | 277,000                                |
| WEEK ENDING                                                 | December 17 | December 10 | Change  | December 3  | <a href="#">Prior Year<sup>1</sup></a> |
| Insured Unemployment (SA)                                   | 2,102,000   | 2,039,000   | +63,000 | 2,021,000   | 2,212,000                              |
| Insured Unemployment (NSA)                                  | 2,108,467   | 2,097,670   | +10,797 | 1,997,189   | 2,191,682                              |
| 4-Wk Moving Average (SA)                                    | 2,042,250   | 2,037,750   | +4,500  | 2,038,750   | 2,220,500                              |
| <a href="#">Insured Unemployment Rate (SA)<sup>2</sup></a>  | 1.5%        | 1.5%        | 0.0     | 1.5%        | 1.6%                                   |
| <a href="#">Insured Unemployment Rate (NSA)<sup>2</sup></a> | 1.5%        | 1.5%        | 0.0     | 1.4%        | 1.6%                                   |

## INITIAL CLAIMS FILED IN FEDERAL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

| WEEK ENDING                     | December 17 | December 10 | Change | <a href="#">Prior Year<sup>1</sup></a> |
|---------------------------------|-------------|-------------|--------|----------------------------------------|
| Federal Employees (UCFE)        | 1,313       | 1,088       | +225   | 1,381                                  |
| Newly Discharged Veterans (UCX) | 947         | 1,083       | -136   | 1,205                                  |

## PERSONS CLAIMING UI BENEFITS IN ALL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

| WEEK ENDING                                           | December 10 | December 3 | Change   | <a href="#">Prior Year<sup>1</sup></a> |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|----------|----------------------------------------|
| Regular State                                         | 2,094,534   | 1,993,028  | +101,506 | 2,282,827                              |
| Federal Employees                                     | 14,066      | 12,006     | +2,060   | 14,969                                 |
| Newly Discharged Veterans                             | 13,250      | 12,528     | +722     | 17,337                                 |
| <a href="#">Extended Benefits<sup>3</sup></a>         | 0           | 0          | 0        | 0                                      |
| <a href="#">State Additional Benefits<sup>4</sup></a> | 7,468       | 7,287      | +181     | 7,440                                  |
| <a href="#">STC / Workshare<sup>5</sup></a>           | 11,147      | 13,186     | -2,039   | 13,946                                 |
| <a href="#">TOTAL</a>                                 | 2,140,465   | 2,038,035  | +102,430 | 2,336,519                              |

### FOOTNOTES

SA - Seasonally Adjusted Data, NSA - Not Seasonally Adjusted Data

1. Prior year is comparable to most recent data.
2. Most recent week used covered employment of 138,322,138 as denominator.
3. Information on the EB program can be found here: [EB Program information](#)
4. Some states maintain additional benefit programs for those claimants who exhaust regular, extended and emergency benefits. Information on states that participate, and the extent of benefits paid, can be found starting on page 4-5 of this link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)
5. Information on STC/Worksharing can be found starting on page 4-9 of the following link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)

## Advance State Claims - Not Seasonally Adjusted

| STATE                | Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended December 24 |          |        | Insured Unemployment For Week Ended December 17 |           |         |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------|--------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
|                      | Advance                                            | Prior Wk | Change | Advance                                         | Prior Wk  | Change  |
| Alabama              | 3,443                                              | 3,402    | 41     | 19,018                                          | 20,165    | -1,147  |
| Alaska               | 1,482                                              | 1,403    | 79     | 13,042                                          | 15,087    | -2,045  |
| Arizona              | 3,132                                              | 3,730    | -598   | 22,218                                          | 25,608    | -3,390  |
| Arkansas             | 3,619                                              | 2,184    | 1,435  | 14,711                                          | 16,061    | -1,350  |
| California           | 52,809                                             | 50,254   | 2,555  | 367,430                                         | 377,184   | -9,754  |
| Colorado             | 2,854                                              | 3,001    | -147   | 28,033                                          | 26,377    | 1,656   |
| Connecticut          | 5,056                                              | 4,635    | 421    | 39,878                                          | 36,534    | 3,344   |
| Delaware             | 949                                                | 710      | 239    | 6,015                                           | 5,433     | 582     |
| District of Columbia | 693                                                | 330      | 363    | 8,175                                           | 8,643     | -468    |
| Florida              | 5,926                                              | 7,322    | -1,396 | 35,771                                          | 44,858    | -9,087  |
| *Georgia             | 5,779                                              | 6,137    | -358   | 28,341                                          | 30,602    | -2,261  |
| **Hawaii             | 1,382                                              | 1,275    | 107    | 7,021                                           | 7,547     | -526    |
| Idaho                | 2,601                                              | 2,649    | -48    | 10,372                                          | 10,362    | 10      |
| Illinois             | 16,934                                             | 19,699   | -2,765 | 126,833                                         | 117,999   | 8,834   |
| Indiana              | 5,620                                              | 6,235    | -615   | 27,776                                          | 24,218    | 3,558   |
| Iowa                 | 8,187                                              | 6,477    | 1,710  | 30,086                                          | 23,827    | 6,259   |
| *Kansas              | 3,854                                              | 3,302    | 552    | 13,513                                          | 11,976    | 1,537   |
| Kentucky             | 8,048                                              | 3,507    | 4,541  | 19,838                                          | 19,531    | 307     |
| Louisiana            | 2,057                                              | 2,637    | -580   | 23,940                                          | 23,892    | 48      |
| Maine                | 1,341                                              | 1,312    | 29     | 7,529                                           | 7,103     | 426     |
| Maryland             | 6,160                                              | 4,785    | 1,375  | 33,850                                          | 35,915    | -2,065  |
| *Massachusetts       | 10,908                                             | 9,780    | 1,128  | 71,604                                          | 67,061    | 4,543   |
| Michigan             | 15,146                                             | 14,073   | 1,073  | 63,430                                          | 67,275    | -3,845  |
| Minnesota            | 7,524                                              | 7,918    | -394   | 65,103                                          | 55,771    | 9,332   |
| Mississippi          | 2,208                                              | 2,079    | 129    | 10,343                                          | 12,021    | -1,678  |
| Missouri             | 8,881                                              | 6,057    | 2,824  | 26,857                                          | 26,619    | 238     |
| Montana              | 1,572                                              | 1,760    | -188   | 11,557                                          | 11,394    | 163     |
| Nebraska             | 2,179                                              | 1,696    | 483    | 7,107                                           | 6,314     | 793     |
| Nevada               | 3,471                                              | 3,229    | 242    | 23,438                                          | 23,737    | -299    |
| New Hampshire        | 833                                                | 834      | -1     | 4,436                                           | 4,500     | -64     |
| New Jersey           | 15,041                                             | 12,563   | 2,478  | 100,409                                         | 95,869    | 4,540   |
| New Mexico           | 1,505                                              | 1,155    | 350    | 11,894                                          | 12,240    | -346    |
| New York             | 21,430                                             | 17,728   | 3,702  | 161,148                                         | 153,299   | 7,849   |
| *North Carolina      | 3,271                                              | 3,947    | -676   | 23,876                                          | 25,053    | -1,177  |
| North Dakota         | 1,530                                              | 1,584    | -54    | 9,361                                           | 6,611     | 2,750   |
| **Ohio               | 17,499                                             | 13,374   | 4,125  | 67,454                                          | 63,471    | 3,983   |
| *Oklahoma            | 2,832                                              | 1,693    | 1,139  | 20,957                                          | 19,013    | 1,944   |
| Oregon               | 7,350                                              | 6,023    | 1,327  | 32,051                                          | 30,408    | 1,643   |
| Pennsylvania         | 20,812                                             | 19,304   | 1,508  | 127,017                                         | 131,777   | -4,760  |
| *Puerto Rico         | 1,179                                              | 1,314    | -135   | 20,262                                          | 21,336    | -1,074  |
| Rhode Island         | 2,417                                              | 1,555    | 862    | 8,896                                           | 8,339     | 557     |
| South Carolina       | 3,040                                              | 3,263    | -223   | 15,074                                          | 15,873    | -799    |
| South Dakota         | 351                                                | 643      | -292   | 3,169                                           | 2,855     | 314     |
| *Tennessee           | 4,645                                              | 3,547    | 1,098  | 18,110                                          | 18,152    | -42     |
| Texas                | 13,791                                             | 15,595   | -1,804 | 155,247                                         | 168,225   | -12,978 |
| Utah                 | 1,760                                              | 1,752    | 8      | 12,335                                          | 11,830    | 505     |
| Vermont              | 1,520                                              | 781      | 739    | 5,121                                           | 4,568     | 553     |
| Virgin Islands       | 6                                                  | 19       | -13    | 580                                             | 760       | -180    |
| Virginia             | 1,794                                              | 3,981    | -2,187 | 19,171                                          | 25,087    | -5,916  |
| Washington           | 10,223                                             | 10,011   | 212    | 60,800                                          | 56,122    | 4,678   |
| West Virginia        | 1,141                                              | 1,561    | -420   | 14,333                                          | 13,857    | 476     |
| Wisconsin            | 11,356                                             | 10,593   | 763    | 48,679                                          | 43,259    | 5,420   |
| Wyoming              | 881                                                | 709      | 172    | 5,258                                           | 6,052     | -794    |
| US Total             | 340,022                                            | 315,107  | 24,915 | 2,108,467                                       | 2,097,670 | 10,797  |

Note: Advance Claims are not directly comparable to claims reported in prior weeks. Advance claims are reported by the state liable for paying the unemployment compensation, whereas previous weeks reported reflect claimants by state of residence. In addition, claims reported as "workshare equivalent" in the previous week are added to the advance claims as a proxy for the current week's "workshare equivalent" activity.

\* Denotes state staff estimate.

\*\*Denotes OUI staff estimate.

## Seasonally Adjusted US Weekly UI Claims (in thousands)

| Week Ending        | Initial<br>Claims | Change<br>from<br>Prior<br>Week | 4-Week<br>Average | Insured<br>Unemployment | Change<br>from<br>Prior<br>Week | 4-Week<br>Average | IUR |
|--------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|-----|
| December 19, 2015  | 269               | -6                              | 274.25            | 2,212                   | 17                              | 2,220.50          | 1.6 |
| December 26, 2015  | 285               | 16                              | 277.00            | 2,226                   | 14                              | 2,219.50          | 1.6 |
| January 2, 2016    | 277               | -8                              | 276.50            | 2,248                   | 22                              | 2,220.25          | 1.6 |
| January 9, 2016    | 280               | 3                               | 277.75            | 2,217                   | -31                             | 2,225.75          | 1.6 |
| January 16, 2016   | 291               | 11                              | 283.25            | 2,250                   | 33                              | 2,235.25          | 1.7 |
| January 23, 2016   | 275               | -16                             | 280.75            | 2,248                   | -2                              | 2,240.75          | 1.6 |
| January 30, 2016   | 286               | 11                              | 283.00            | 2,234                   | -14                             | 2,237.25          | 1.6 |
| February 6, 2016   | 259               | -27                             | 277.75            | 2,249                   | 15                              | 2,245.25          | 1.7 |
| February 13, 2016  | 260               | 1                               | 270.00            | 2,233                   | -16                             | 2,241.00          | 1.6 |
| February 20, 2016  | 264               | 4                               | 267.25            | 2,231                   | -2                              | 2,236.75          | 1.6 |
| February 27, 2016  | 262               | -2                              | 261.25            | 2,198                   | -33                             | 2,227.75          | 1.6 |
| March 5, 2016      | 253               | -9                              | 259.75            | 2,212                   | 14                              | 2,218.50          | 1.6 |
| March 12, 2016     | 259               | 6                               | 259.50            | 2,180                   | -32                             | 2,205.25          | 1.6 |
| March 19, 2016     | 265               | 6                               | 259.75            | 2,172                   | -8                              | 2,190.50          | 1.6 |
| March 26, 2016     | 276               | 11                              | 263.25            | 2,189                   | 17                              | 2,188.25          | 1.6 |
| April 2, 2016      | 266               | -10                             | 266.50            | 2,176                   | -13                             | 2,179.25          | 1.6 |
| April 9, 2016      | 253               | -13                             | 265.00            | 2,135                   | -41                             | 2,168.00          | 1.6 |
| April 16, 2016     | 248               | -5                              | 260.75            | 2,129                   | -6                              | 2,157.25          | 1.6 |
| April 23, 2016     | 257               | 9                               | 256.00            | 2,124                   | -5                              | 2,141.00          | 1.6 |
| April 30, 2016     | 274               | 17                              | 258.00            | 2,165                   | 41                              | 2,138.25          | 1.6 |
| May 7, 2016        | 294               | 20                              | 268.25            | 2,153                   | -12                             | 2,142.75          | 1.6 |
| May 14, 2016       | 278               | -16                             | 275.75            | 2,160                   | 7                               | 2,150.50          | 1.6 |
| May 21, 2016       | 268               | -10                             | 278.50            | 2,172                   | 12                              | 2,162.50          | 1.6 |
| May 28, 2016       | 268               | 0                               | 277.00            | 2,112                   | -60                             | 2,149.25          | 1.5 |
| June 4, 2016       | 264               | -4                              | 269.50            | 2,162                   | 50                              | 2,151.50          | 1.6 |
| June 11, 2016      | 277               | 13                              | 269.25            | 2,139                   | -23                             | 2,146.25          | 1.6 |
| June 18, 2016      | 258               | -19                             | 266.75            | 2,167                   | 28                              | 2,145.00          | 1.6 |
| June 25, 2016      | 270               | 12                              | 267.25            | 2,117                   | -50                             | 2,146.25          | 1.5 |
| July 2, 2016       | 254               | -16                             | 264.75            | 2,153                   | 36                              | 2,144.00          | 1.6 |
| July 9, 2016       | 254               | 0                               | 259.00            | 2,132                   | -21                             | 2,142.25          | 1.5 |
| July 16, 2016      | 252               | -2                              | 257.50            | 2,144                   | 12                              | 2,136.50          | 1.6 |
| July 23, 2016      | 266               | 14                              | 256.50            | 2,141                   | -3                              | 2,142.50          | 1.6 |
| July 30, 2016      | 267               | 1                               | 259.75            | 2,160                   | 19                              | 2,144.25          | 1.6 |
| August 6, 2016     | 266               | -1                              | 262.75            | 2,175                   | 15                              | 2,155.00          | 1.6 |
| August 13, 2016    | 262               | -4                              | 265.25            | 2,145                   | -30                             | 2,155.25          | 1.6 |
| August 20, 2016    | 261               | -1                              | 264.00            | 2,157                   | 12                              | 2,159.25          | 1.6 |
| August 27, 2016    | 263               | 2                               | 263.00            | 2,142                   | -15                             | 2,154.75          | 1.6 |
| September 3, 2016  | 259               | -4                              | 261.25            | 2,149                   | 7                               | 2,148.25          | 1.6 |
| September 10, 2016 | 260               | 1                               | 260.75            | 2,108                   | -41                             | 2,139.00          | 1.5 |
| September 17, 2016 | 251               | -9                              | 258.25            | 2,064                   | -44                             | 2,115.75          | 1.5 |
| September 24, 2016 | 254               | 3                               | 256.00            | 2,062                   | -2                              | 2,095.75          | 1.5 |
| October 1, 2016    | 246               | -8                              | 252.75            | 2,050                   | -12                             | 2,071.00          | 1.5 |
| October 8, 2016    | 247               | 1                               | 249.50            | 2,054                   | 4                               | 2,057.50          | 1.5 |
| October 15, 2016   | 261               | 14                              | 252.00            | 2,040                   | -14                             | 2,051.50          | 1.5 |
| October 22, 2016   | 259               | -2                              | 253.25            | 2,030                   | -10                             | 2,043.50          | 1.5 |
| October 29, 2016   | 266               | 7                               | 258.25            | 2,043                   | 13                              | 2,041.75          | 1.5 |
| November 5, 2016   | 254               | -12                             | 260.00            | 1,983                   | -60                             | 2,024.00          | 1.4 |
| November 12, 2016  | 233               | -21                             | 253.00            | 2,043                   | 60                              | 2,024.75          | 1.5 |
| November 19, 2016  | 251               | 18                              | 251.00            | 2,084                   | 41                              | 2,038.25          | 1.5 |
| November 26, 2016  | 268               | 17                              | 251.50            | 2,007                   | -77                             | 2,029.25          | 1.5 |
| December 3, 2016   | 258               | -10                             | 252.50            | 2,021                   | 14                              | 2,038.75          | 1.5 |
| December 10, 2016  | 254               | -4                              | 257.75            | 2,039                   | 18                              | 2,037.75          | 1.5 |
| December 17, 2016  | 275               | 21                              | 263.75            | 2,102                   | 63                              | 2,042.25          | 1.5 |
| December 24, 2016  | 265               | -10                             | 263.00            |                         |                                 |                   |     |

Initial Claims Filed During Week Ended December  
17

Insured Unemployment For Week Ended December 10  
INSURED UNEMPLOYMENT

| STATE                | INITIAL CLAIMS<br>CHANGE FROM |           |          |                   |                  |         | INSURED UNEMPLOYMENT<br>CHANGE FROM |           |          |                   | ALL PROGRAMS EXCLUDING RAILROAD<br>RETIREMENT |                  |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|-----------|----------|-------------------|------------------|---------|-------------------------------------|-----------|----------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------|
|                      | STATE                         | LAST WEEK | YEAR AGO | UCFE <sup>1</sup> | UCX <sup>1</sup> | STATE   | (%)<br><sup>2</sup>                 | LAST WEEK | YEAR AGO | UCFE <sup>1</sup> |                                               | UCX <sup>1</sup> |
| Alabama              | 3402                          | 256       | 73       | 6                 | 6                | 20165   | 1.1                                 | 338       | -2094    | 69                | 135                                           | 20369            |
| Alaska               | 1403                          | -62       | -25      | 10                | 1                | 15087   | 4.8                                 | 2317      | -154     | 239               | 34                                            | 15360            |
| Arizona              | 3730                          | -320      | -115     | 42                | 4                | 25608   | 1.0                                 | 664       | -1189    | 190               | 128                                           | 25926            |
| Arkansas             | 2184                          | -299      | -1274    | 9                 | 7                | 16061   | 1.4                                 | 450       | -4903    | 100               | 92                                            | 16253            |
| California           | 50254                         | -383      | -2746    | 224               | 163              | 377184  | 2.3                                 | 10694     | -10306   | 3443              | 2712                                          | 383339           |
| Colorado             | 3001                          | -818      | -766     | 37                | 32               | 26377   | 1.1                                 | 904       | -3833    | 336               | 523                                           | 27236            |
| Connecticut          | 4635                          | 566       | -82      | 7                 | 6                | 36534   | 2.2                                 | 277       | -1261    | 81                | 117                                           | 36732            |
| Delaware             | 710                           | 9         | -87      | 3                 | 3                | 5433    | 1.3                                 | 78        | -794     | 12                | 14                                            | 5459             |
| District of Columbia | 330                           | -42       | -41      | 10                | 2                | 8643    | 1.6                                 | 235       | 318      | 293               | 10                                            | 8946             |
| Florida              | 7322                          | -808      | -1019    | 21                | 64               | 44858   | 0.6                                 | 4347      | -9041    | 202               | 266                                           | 45326            |
| Georgia              | 6137                          | -1500     | -872     | 25                | 27               | 30602   | 0.7                                 | 57        | -5511    | 244               | 380                                           | 31226            |
| Hawaii               | 1275                          | 42        | 228      | 3                 | 12               | 7547    | 1.2                                 | 189       | 1318     | 65                | 125                                           | 7737             |
| Idaho                | 2649                          | -52       | 230      | 54                | 6                | 10362   | 1.6                                 | 1189      | -1208    | 251               | 43                                            | 10656            |
| Illinois             | 19699                         | -101      | 2495     | 9                 | 16               | 117999  | 2.0                                 | 10684     | -17013   | 424               | 384                                           | 118807           |
| Indiana              | 6235                          | 1099      | 865      | 5                 | 8                | 24218   | 0.8                                 | 1868      | -2021    | 89                | 75                                            | 24382            |
| Iowa                 | 6477                          | 868       | 1592     | 5                 | 4                | 23827   | 1.6                                 | 2994      | -1339    | 44                | 59                                            | 23930            |
| Kansas               | 3302                          | 182       | -150     | 4                 | 3                | 11976   | 0.9                                 | 915       | -2196    | 69                | 76                                            | 12121            |
| Kentucky             | 3507                          | 207       | -702     | 42                | 9                | 19531   | 1.1                                 | -55       | -3345    | 270               | 247                                           | 20048            |
| Louisiana            | 2637                          | -227      | -38      | 0                 | 0                | 23892   | 1.3                                 | 236       | 2103     | 55                | 51                                            | 23998            |
| Maine                | 1312                          | -27       | -225     | 5                 | 1                | 7103    | 1.2                                 | 490       | -1569    | 35                | 19                                            | 7157             |
| Maryland             | 4785                          | 656       | 36       | 21                | 21               | 35915   | 1.5                                 | 342       | -3586    | 311               | 190                                           | 36416            |
| Massachusetts        | 9780                          | 1510      | 542      | 14                | 13               | 67061   | 2.0                                 | 2406      | -4383    | 195               | 235                                           | 67491            |
| Michigan             | 14073                         | 1683      | 2787     | 31                | 28               | 67275   | 1.6                                 | 11622     | -8183    | 257               | 262                                           | 67794            |
| Minnesota            | 7918                          | 527       | 863      | 21                | 5                | 55771   | 2.0                                 | 2780      | -1859    | 94                | 114                                           | 55979            |
| Mississippi          | 2079                          | 322       | -184     | 31                | 0                | 12021   | 1.1                                 | 462       | -1253    | 72                | 45                                            | 12138            |
| Missouri             | 6057                          | 801       | -441     | 19                | 2                | 26619   | 1.0                                 | 2064      | -4644    | 340               | 68                                            | 27027            |
| Montana              | 1760                          | -608      | -49      | 72                | 5                | 11394   | 2.6                                 | 1843      | -598     | 491               | 35                                            | 11920            |
| Nebraska             | 1696                          | 31        | -74      | 4                 | 1                | 6314    | 0.7                                 | 934       | -329     | 15                | 14                                            | 6343             |
| Nevada               | 3229                          | 196       | -284     | 20                | 7                | 23737   | 1.9                                 | 465       | -3433    | 205               | 104                                           | 24046            |
| New Hampshire        | 834                           | 55        | -119     | 0                 | 0                | 4500    | 0.7                                 | 151       | -637     | 7                 | 7                                             | 4514             |
| New Jersey           | 12563                         | 1380      | 1397     | 14                | 23               | 95869   | 2.5                                 | 2147      | -5825    | 284               | 394                                           | 96547            |
| New Mexico           | 1155                          | 20        | -136     | 20                | 0                | 12240   | 1.6                                 | 353       | -1182    | 320               | 85                                            | 12645            |
| New York             | 17728                         | 437       | -657     | 21                | 31               | 153299  | 1.7                                 | 3285      | -11492   | 324               | 601                                           | 154224           |
| North Carolina       | 3947                          | -310      | -676     | 7                 | 24               | 25053   | 0.6                                 | 691       | -4608    | 131               | 290                                           | 25474            |
| North Dakota         | 1584                          | -212      | -56      | 3                 | 2                | 6611    | 1.6                                 | 898       | 452      | 12                | 1                                             | 6624             |
| Ohio                 | 13374                         | 2625      | 501      | 12                | 30               | 63471   | 1.2                                 | 3102      | -7674    | 149               | 332                                           | 63952            |
| Oklahoma             | 1693                          | -46       | -406     | 13                | 9                | 19013   | 1.2                                 | -397      | -2436    | 76                | 169                                           | 19258            |
| Oregon               | 6023                          | 776       | -187     | 100               | 16               | 30408   | 1.7                                 | 1026      | -4400    | 562               | 169                                           | 31139            |
| Pennsylvania         | 19304                         | -1521     | -2463    | 76                | 53               | 131777  | 2.3                                 | 4148      | -16641   | 805               | 518                                           | 133100           |
| Puerto Rico          | 1314                          | -168      | -488     | 2                 | 1                | 21336   | 2.4                                 | -862      | -4906    | 45                | 122                                           | 21503            |
| Rhode Island         | 1555                          | 460       | 138      | 3                 | 2                | 8339    | 1.8                                 | 226       | -613     | 23                | 31                                            | 8393             |
| South Carolina       | 3263                          | 262       | -463     | 10                | 15               | 15873   | 0.8                                 | 530       | -1978    | 50                | 139                                           | 16062            |
| South Dakota         | 643                           | -53       | 72       | 7                 | 1                | 2855    | 0.7                                 | 341       | 274      | 31                | 7                                             | 2893             |
| Tennessee            | 3547                          | 26        | -542     | 9                 | 3                | 18152   | 0.7                                 | 470       | -5602    | 404               | 60                                            | 18616            |
| Texas                | 15595                         | 86        | -421     | 62                | 144              | 168225  | 1.5                                 | 17018     | -9611    | 848               | 2339                                          | 171412           |
| Utah                 | 1752                          | -265      | -740     | 65                | 2                | 11830   | 0.9                                 | 750       | -1021    | 285               | 28                                            | 12143            |
| Vermont              | 781                           | 115       | 112      | 1                 | 0                | 4568    | 1.5                                 | 133       | -173     | 20                | 12                                            | 4600             |
| Virgin Islands       | 19                            | -1        | -11      | 1                 | 0                | 760     | 2.1                                 | 214       | 112      | 0                 | 2                                             | 762              |
| Virginia             | 3981                          | 206       | -1946    | 30                | 27               | 25087   | 0.7                                 | 266       | -2933    | 302               | 489                                           | 25878            |
| Washington           | 10011                         | 1018      | 1167     | 65                | 94               | 56122   | 1.8                                 | 1017      | -5281    | 518               | 757                                           | 57397            |
| West Virginia        | 1561                          | -737      | -435     | 3                 | 7                | 13857   | 2.1                                 | -909      | -3722    | 43                | 53                                            | 13953            |
| Wisconsin            | 10593                         | 2083      | 1421     | 20                | 7                | 43259   | 1.6                                 | 2321      | -6147    | 124               | 58                                            | 43441            |
| Wyoming              | 709                           | -170      | -133     | 15                | 0                | 6052    | 2.2                                 | 1773      | -705     | 212               | 30                                            | 6294             |
| Totals               | 315107                        | 9774      | -4534    | 1313              | 947              | 2097670 | 1.5                                 | 100481    | -189055  | 14066             | 13250                                         | 2124986          |

Figures Appearing In columns showing Over-The-Week Changes reflect all revisions in data for prior week submitted by State agencies.

1. The Unemployment Compensation program for Federal Employees (UCFE) and the Unemployment Compensation for Ex-servicemembers (UCX) exclude claims filed jointly under other programs to avoid duplication.
2. Rate is not seasonally adjusted. The source of US total covered employment is BLS.

**UNADJUSTED INITIAL CLAIMS FOR WEEK ENDED DECEMBER 17, 2016**

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**STATES WITH AN INCREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000**

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| <b>State</b> | <b>Change</b> | <b>State Supplied Comment</b>                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OH           | +2,625        | Layoffs in the transportation and warehousing and retail trade industries.                                                                                    |
| WI           | +2,083        | No comment.                                                                                                                                                   |
| MI           | +1,683        | Layoffs in the construction industry.                                                                                                                         |
| MA           | +1,510        | Layoffs in the accommodation and food service, construction, manufacturing, and administrative, support, waste management and remediation service industries. |
| NJ           | +1,380        | Layoffs in the accommodation and food service industry.                                                                                                       |
| IN           | +1,099        | No comment.                                                                                                                                                   |
| WA           | +1,018        | Layoffs in the agriculture, forestry, fishing and hunting, wholesale trade, educational service, and construction industries.                                 |

**STATES WITH A DECREASE OF MORE THAN 1,000**

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| <b>State</b> | <b>Change</b> | <b>State Supplied Comment</b>                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PA           | -1,521        | Fewer layoffs in the transportation and warehousing, administrative, support, waste management and remediation service, and arts, entertainment, and recreation industries. |
| GA           | -1,500        | Fewer layoffs in the manufacturing and administrative, support, waste management and remediation service industries.                                                        |

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## TECHNICAL NOTES

This news release presents the weekly unemployment insurance (UI) claims reported by each state's unemployment insurance program offices. These claims may be used for monitoring workload volume, assessing state program operations and for assessing labor market conditions. States initially report claims directly taken by the state liable for the benefit payments, regardless of where the claimant who filed the claim resided. These are the basis for the advance initial claims and continued claims reported each week. These data come from ETA 538, Advance Weekly Initial and Continued Claims Report. The following week initial claims and continued claims are revised based on a second reporting by states that reflect the claimants by state of residence. These data come from the ETA 539, Weekly Claims and Extended Benefits Trigger Data Report.

### A. Initial Claims

An initial claim is a claim filed by an unemployed individual after a separation from an employer. The claimant requests a determination of basic eligibility for the UI program. When an initial claim is filed with a state, certain programmatic activities take place and these result in activity counts including the count of initial claims. The count of U.S. initial claims for unemployment insurance is a leading economic indicator because it is an indication of emerging labor market conditions in the country. However, these are weekly administrative data which are difficult to seasonally adjust, making the series subject to some volatility.

### B. Continued Weeks Claimed

A person who has already filed an initial claim and who has experienced a week of unemployment then files a continued claim to claim benefits for that week of unemployment. Continued claims are also referred to as insured unemployment. The count of U.S. continued weeks claimed is also a good indicator of labor market conditions. Continued claims reflect the current number of insured unemployed workers filing for UI benefits in the nation. While continued claims are not a leading indicator (they roughly coincide with economic cycles at their peaks and lag at cycle troughs), they provide confirming evidence of the direction of the U.S. economy.

### C. Seasonal Adjustments and Annual Revisions

Over the course of a year, the weekly changes in the levels of initial claims and continued claims undergo regularly occurring fluctuations. These fluctuations may result from seasonal changes in weather, major holidays, the opening and closing of schools, or other similar events. Because these seasonal events follow a more or less regular pattern each year, their influence on the level of a series can be tempered by adjusting for regular seasonal variation. These adjustments make trend and cycle developments easier to spot. At the beginning of each calendar year, the Bureau of Labor Statistics provides the Employment and Training Administration (ETA) with a set of seasonal factors to apply to the unadjusted data during that year. Concurrent with the implementation and release of the new seasonal factors, ETA incorporates revisions to the UI claims historical series caused by updates to the unadjusted data.

#### [Weekly Claims Archives](#)

#### [Weekly Claims Data](#)

U.S. Department of Labor news materials are accessible at <http://www.dol.gov>. The Department's [Reasonable Accommodation Resource Center](#) converts Departmental information and documents into alternative formats, which include Braille and large print. For alternative format requests, please contact the Department at (202) 693-7828 (voice) or (800) 877-8339 (federal relay).

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